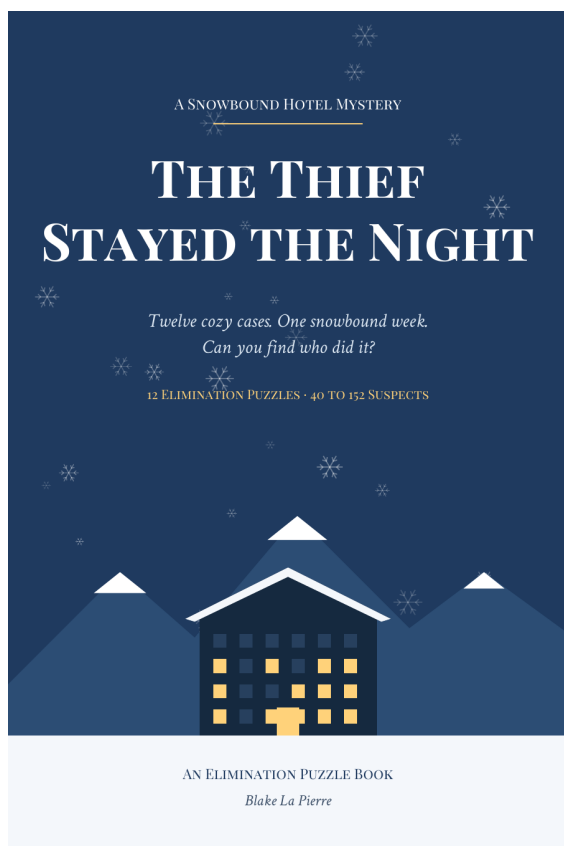


THE THIEF STAYED THE NIGHT

A FREE PRINTABLE SAMPLE • WITH ANSWERS



WHAT'S INSIDE

- Case One: The Cocoa Tin
- The story, the guest register and all the clues
- A verdict page to record your answer
- The full step-by-step solution

HOW TO PRINT

- US Letter paper, portrait.
- Choose “Actual size” or “Fit”.
- Grab a pencil and an eraser.
- Answers are at the back. No peeking!

ENJOYED THESE PUZZLES?

The full book, *The Thief Stayed the Night*, is a paperback on Amazon.
amazon.com/dp/B0HLMMS675

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Every puzzle is checked by computer to have exactly one solution.

*More in *The Thief Stayed the Night* by Blake La Pierre on Amazon*

CASE ONE · MONDAY MORNING

THE COCOA TIN



40 suspects · 6 clues · Difficulty ❄️❄️❄️❄️

EVERY night at Frostwood ends with cocoa hour in the Great Hall, and every cup of cocoa begins with Mrs. Brisket's tin. It is a battered old thing, painted with faded edelweiss, and it holds *Brisket's Blend*: a secret mixture of cocoa and spices that Mrs. Brisket's grandmother invented and that nobody else has ever seen written down.

On Sunday night, with the snow piling up against the windows and the road gone for good, cocoa hour was especially popular. forty guests squeezed into the Great Hall. Some sat in the big chairs by the Fireside, some on the cushions by the Window, and some around the old Piano, where a guest was playing the only three tunes the piano still remembered.

At eleven o'clock, Mrs. Brisket went to the kitchen to fetch more milk. She left the tin on the serving table, between the marshmallows and the cinnamon, as she has done every night for twenty-two years.

When she came back, the tin was gone.

"Gone!" she said, so loudly that the piano stopped. "My grandmother's tin! Nobody leaves this hall until it is found!"

Unfortunately everybody had already left, because it was bedtime and Mrs. Brisket had been in the kitchen for quite a long time, looking for the good milk. By the time Mr. Pemberton arrived in his dressing gown, the Great Hall was empty except for forty dirty mugs and one very cross cook.

At breakfast on Monday, Pippa presented you with a list of every guest who had been at cocoa hour, showing where each had been sitting and what they had put on top of their cocoa. ("I wrote it down at the time," she said. "I write everything down at the time.") Mr. Grayle, eating toast at the next table, sniffed. "A missing tin of cocoa," he said. "First day of the snow. Trouble, Pemberton. I told you."

Mr. Pemberton turned pink. "You'll find it, won't you?" he whispered to you. "Mrs. Brisket won't make another cup until you do."

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 40 guests who were at Sunday's cocoa hour, listed alphabetically by surname. Room numbers tell you the floor: Room 214 is on the 2nd floor. Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Floor	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Topping	Seat
☐ Bellweather, Una	413	4	Saturday	Minneapolis	Teacher	Marshmallows	Fireside
☐ Carrington, Primrose	514	5	Friday	Phoenix	Accountant	Whipped Cream	Piano
☐ Chalk, Maude	416	4	Friday	Anchorage	Librarian	Marshmallows	Window
☐ Elphick, Arthur	504	5	Sunday	Montreal	Teacher	Nothing	Piano
☐ Elphick, Nigel	504	5	Sunday	Montreal	Florist	Nothing	Window
☐ Elphick, Otis	504	5	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Cinnamon	Piano
☐ Everley, Magnus	519	5	Friday	Denver	Novelist	Nothing	Piano
☐ Finch, Roland	215	2	Sunday	Honolulu	Pilot	Whipped Cream	Fireside
☐ Foxley, Frank	409	4	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	Nothing	Window
☐ Foxley, Kitty	409	4	Sunday	San Diego	Dentist	Marshmallows	Piano
☐ Gallagher, Flora	210	2	Saturday	Denver	Beekeeper	Cinnamon	Window
☐ Greaves, Honor	404	4	Sunday	Chicago	Painter	Cinnamon	Window
☐ Hawthorne, Dexter	120	1	Saturday	Denver	Architect	Marshmallows	Window
☐ Hawthorne, Ralph	120	1	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Whipped Cream	Window
☐ Juniper, Gordon	213	2	Saturday	Milwaukee	Librarian	Cinnamon	Window
☐ Kemble, Amos	219	2	Saturday	Chicago	Beekeeper	Cinnamon	Window
☐ Kemble, Hugo	219	2	Saturday	Chicago	Novelist	Cinnamon	Window
☐ Kemble, Oscar	219	2	Saturday	Chicago	Student	Nothing	Window
☐ Kettering, Harold	311	3	Sunday	Boston	Pilot	Nothing	Piano
☐ Kettering, Ophelia	311	3	Sunday	Boston	Tailor	Cinnamon	Fireside
☐ Kingsley, Eleanor	105	1	Saturday	Buffalo	Teacher	Whipped Cream	Fireside
☐ Kingsley, Xavier	105	1	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Nothing	Window
☐ Loxley, Cecil	404	4	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Cinnamon	Fireside
☐ Mottram, Rupert	318	3	Sunday	Denver	Tailor	Marshmallows	Fireside
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	2	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist	Cinnamon	Piano
☐ Ogilvy, Minnie	110	1	Sunday	Phoenix	Beekeeper	Marshmallows	Window
☐ Pilbeam, Hazel	516	5	Saturday	Buffalo	Botanist	Whipped Cream	Fireside
☐ Pilbeam, Isadora	516	5	Saturday	Buffalo	Chef	Cinnamon	Fireside
☐ Snowden, Dudley	313	3	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Nothing	Window
☐ Snowden, Horace	313	3	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	Nothing	Fireside
☐ Snowden, Ignatius	313	3	Sunday	Phoenix	Lawyer	Nothing	Piano
☐ Thistlewood, Wallace	502	5	Sunday	Buffalo	Teacher	Cinnamon	Piano
☐ Upton, Jasper	201	2	Saturday	Los Angeles	Beekeeper	Whipped Cream	Piano
☐ Upton, Pearl	201	2	Saturday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Nothing	Piano
☐ Wetherby, Ivor	415	4	Friday	San Diego	Nurse	Marshmallows	Fireside
☐ Wetherby, Wilhelmina	415	4	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Whipped Cream	Fireside
☐ Yardley, Cora	308	3	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Whipped Cream	Window
☐ Yardley, Orla	308	3	Saturday	Minneapolis	Dentist	Cinnamon	Fireside

	Guest	Room	Floor	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Topping	Seat
☐	Yelland, Lark	114	1	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Nothing	Fireside
☐	Yelland, Queenie	114	1	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Whipped Cream	Fireside

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 THE FIRESIDE CHAIRS

Pippa spent the whole of cocoa hour curled up in the big armchair by the fire, reading. She is certain that nobody sitting in the Fireside chairs got up between ten and eleven, because every one of them was listening to Lady Winifred's story about the time she met a polar bear.

The thief's Seat is not Fireside.

2 EARLY TO BED

The guests who arrived on Friday had signed up for Monday's dawn snowshoe walk. At a quarter to eleven Gus marched them all into the boot room to wax their snowshoes, and he kept them there, waxing and grumbling, until well after midnight.

The thief did not arrive on Friday.

3 PLAIN COCOA

Mrs. Brisket has one firm rule: anyone who takes their cocoa with Nothing on top collects it from the kitchen hatch and never goes near the serving table, where the toppings (and the tin) were kept.

The thief's Topping is not Nothing.

4 THE LANDING

Dot was polishing the banisters on the 3rd-floor landing from eleven until midnight. Nobody went past her, up or down, and the lift had been switched off for the night. The thief carried the tin straight up to their room.

The thief's room is on the 1st or 2nd floor.

5 SNOW BACK HOME

The thief was overheard at the serving table saying, “Snow like this? We get it every winter back home.” Of the sixteen home cities that Frostwood guests come from, these are the ones that get heavy snow every winter: Anchorage, Boston, Buffalo, Chicago, Denver, Milwaukee, Minneapolis, Montreal, Quebec City and Toronto.

The thief lives in one of these ten cities: Anchorage, Boston, Buffalo, Chicago, Denver, Milwaukee, Minneapolis, Montreal, Quebec City or Toronto.

6 THE STICKY SHELF

On the shelf where the tin had stood, Mrs. Brisket found a sticky, sugary thumbprint, pink and white and unmistakably marshmallow.

The thief's Topping is Marshmallows.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO TOOK THE COCOA TIN?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6
Left						

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE ONE · THE COCOA TIN · SOLUTION

DEXTER HAWTHORNE



Room 120 · Architect from Denver

Starting suspects: 40

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. The Fireside Chairs. Guests seated at the Fireside are cleared.	14	26
2. Early to Bed. Friday arrivals are cleared.	3	23
3. Plain Cocoa. Guests who took Nothing on top are cleared.	9	14
4. The Landing. Guests on floors 3, 4 and 5 are cleared.	5	9
5. Snow Back Home. Guests from Honolulu, Los Angeles, Miami, Phoenix, San Diego and Tampa are cleared.	3	6
6. The Sticky Shelf. Everyone who did not take Marshmallows is cleared.	5	1

Before the final clue, six suspects remained: Flora Gallagher (Room 210), Ralph Hawthorne (Room 120), Gordon Juniper (Room 213), Amos Kemble (Room 219), Hugo Kemble (Room 219) and Dexter Hawthorne (Room 120). The final clue, *The Sticky Shelf*, says: *The thief's Topping is Marshmallows*. Only Dexter fits, so Dexter Hawthorne is the culprit.

The tin was found under Dexter's pillow, its lid still firmly shut. It turned out that Dexter Hawthorne, an architect from Denver, had simply been desperate to know what was in *Brisket's Blend*, but the famous lid is stuck fast and only opens for Mrs. Brisket. "I tried for two hours," Dexter admitted. Mrs. Brisket was so pleased that her tin had defeated a professional that she forgave Dexter on the spot, on condition of washing every cocoa mug for the rest of the week. She opened the lid with one flick of her thumb, and cocoa hour resumed that evening. Gus's scarf reached his knees.